ROALLA



ROALLA MANAGER IMPLEMENTATION GUIDE

Sustainable Work Manager Playbook

Turn priorities capacity boundaries and support into repeatable team practices

Prepared for chief executives, boards, human resources, health and safety, operations, people leaders and employees

Prepared by ROALLA Transformation and Technology Advisory

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Purpose

This playbook gives managers a practical operating system for making work visible, limiting overload, negotiating priorities, protecting recovery and responding appropriately when an employee raises a wellbeing concern. It does not ask managers to diagnose or provide counselling.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

A manager protects sustainable performance by making trade-offs, clarifying expectations, listening without diagnosis and escalating structural problems. The most useful conversation converts vague pressure into specific demand, capacity, control, support and boundary decisions.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Should a manager tell an employee to be more resilient?	**NO**	First examine demand, control, clarity, support and work conditions.
Can every urgent request be accepted?	**NO**	A new commitment requires a trade-off, added capacity or changed expectation.
Should the team board display health information?	**NO**	Show work status and capacity, never confidential personal information.
Can a manager promise confidentiality in every case?	**NO**	Explain limits and involve qualified functions where safety or obligations require it.
What should managers begin now?	**PURSUE**	A weekly capacity and priority review with explicit WIP limits.

Recommended Management Posture

Use the decision model to convert concern into verified work evidence, explicit ownership and sequenced action. A weighted score supports prioritization, but a material safety, privacy or professional-support issue overrides an attractive average.

Questions for Discussion

1. What is the team already committed to deliver?
2. How much capacity remains after operational and support work?
3. What must move if this new request is accepted?
4. Which interruptions or meetings create avoidable cognitive load?
5. Can employees raise workload concerns safely?
6. What information must remain confidential?
7. When should a manager involve HR or another qualified resource?
8. How will we know that the work condition improved?

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Manager Practice Gates

These gates separate organizational responsibilities, manager practices and voluntary individual tools. A high score cannot override an unsafe workload, a material psychosocial hazard or a need for qualified professional support.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Capacity	Committed work fits available team capacity	Time, skills, absences, support load and unplanned demand
02	Priority	Important work is distinguished from noise	Consequences, deadlines, owners, sequencing and trade-offs
03	Flow	Work in progress remains visible and limited	Ready, active, blocked, waiting and completed work
04	Focus	Attention is protected	Meeting discipline, notifications, focus blocks and interruption rules
05	Conversation	Employees can raise pressure safely	Listening, questions, confidentiality and agreed follow-up
06	Boundary	Recovery expectations are explicit	After-hours response, emergencies, vacation and coverage
07	Support	Managers know when and how to refer	HR, health and safety, EAP, accommodation and urgent help
08	Learning	The team reviews work conditions	Indicators, retrospectives, experiments and corrective action

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

Readiness Dimensions

No.	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Demand visibility	Commitments, unplanned work, deadlines, support load and capacity	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Priority quality	Importance, urgency, consequences, ownership and trade-offs	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Flow and focus	Work in progress, blockers, interruptions, meetings and deep work	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Psychological safety	Listening, participation, civility, fairness and escalation	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	Boundaries and support	Disconnection, coverage, accommodation, referral and follow-up	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Management learning	Indicators, experiments, retrospectives and systemic correction	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Capacity	Committed work fits available team capacity	Time, skills, absences, support load and unplanned demand
Priority	Important work is distinguished from noise	Consequences, deadlines, owners, sequencing and trade-offs
Flow	Work in progress remains visible and limited	Ready, active, blocked, waiting and completed work
Focus	Attention is protected	Meeting discipline, notifications, focus blocks and interruption rules
Conversation	Employees can raise pressure safely	Listening, questions, confidentiality and agreed follow-up
Boundary	Recovery expectations are explicit	After-hours response, emergencies, vacation and coverage
Support	Managers know when and how to refer	HR, health and safety, EAP, accommodation and urgent help
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ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Weekly Capacity and Priority Review

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	List committed outcomes and material deadlines before discussing new requests.	☐	☐	_____
A02	Estimate realistic capacity after meetings, support, absences and operational duties.	☐	☐	_____
A03	Limit active work and place future work in a clearly ordered ready queue.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Identify blocked work, the needed decision and the accountable unblocker.	☐	☐	_____
A05	Apply the Eisenhower Matrix only after confirming business importance and consequences.	☐	☐	_____
A06	Ask what current commitment moves when new urgent work is accepted.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Separate a true emergency from poor planning or another person's preference.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Reserve capacity for unplanned work where the operating context requires it.	☐	☐	_____
A09	Protect focus periods and reduce low-value meetings and notifications.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Document the trade-offs and communicate changed expectations to stakeholders.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Wellbeing Conversation and Escalation

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	Meet privately and describe observed work conditions without diagnosing the employee.	☐	☐	_____
B02	Ask what feels unclear, unmanageable, unsupported or outside the employee's control.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Listen without demanding disclosure of a diagnosis or private health details.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Clarify immediate priorities and identify work that can stop, move, simplify or transfer.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Explain confidentiality and any limits before recording or sharing information.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Connect the employee with HR, EAP, accommodation or qualified professional support as appropriate.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Escalate urgent safety concerns through the organization's approved process.	☐	☐	_____
B08	Agree specific actions, owners and a near-term follow-up date.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Review whether the same work condition affects other employees or teams.	☐	☐	_____
B10	Correct the system and monitor outcomes rather than treating the conversation as complete.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Demand visibility	20%	Commitments, unplanned work, deadlines, support load and capacity	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Priority quality	20%	Importance, urgency, consequences, ownership and trade-offs	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Flow and focus	15%	Work in progress, blockers, interruptions, meetings and deep work	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Psychological safety	15%	Listening, participation, civility, fairness and escalation	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Boundaries and support	15%	Disconnection, coverage, accommodation, referral and follow-up	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Management learning	15%	Indicators, experiments, retrospectives and systemic correction	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Pilot the manager practices with a small group, protect confidentiality and measure whether work conditions change rather than counting training attendance alone.



READINESS OPERATING PLAN

Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Establish	Confirm sponsorship, scope, safeguards and the current evidence for manager workload, priority and support practices.	Approved mandate and safeguards
Days 16 to 35	Assess	Gather anonymous input, review workload and work patterns, and identify psychosocial hazards.	Evidence and risk baseline
Days 36 to 55	Design	Define practical controls, manager practices, employee resources and measurement methods.	Target operating approach
Days 56 to 75	Pilot	Test changes with representative teams, protect confidentiality and collect feedback.	Validated pilot findings
Days 76 to 90	Mobilize	Approve owners, policies, training, measures, communication and review dates.	90-day implementation plan

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: train managers, establish capacity reviews and correct urgent workload and boundary issues.
- Quarter 2: standardize priority, meeting, communication, escalation and referral practices.
- Quarters 3 and 4: connect team evidence to workforce planning, change portfolios and leadership scorecards.
- Year 2: refresh manager capability and use recurring evidence to improve work design.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA equips managers with practical work-management routines while coordinating human resources, health and safety, technology and executive sponsorship. The playbook keeps managers within role and routes clinical, legal or accommodation matters to qualified professionals.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Manager practice design	Define capacity, priority, meeting, boundary, conversation and escalation standards.
Work visualization	Configure practical team boards and WIP policies without exposing personal information.
Conversation training	Build listening, workload negotiation, documentation and referral capability.
Technology settings	Align messaging, notifications, calendars and status conventions with operating expectations.
Pilot facilitation	Test practices with teams and convert feedback into usable standards.
Policy integration	Connect manager routines with HR, accommodation, EAP and health and safety processes.
Measurement	Track demand, interruptions, overtime, after-hours work, absence and employee feedback responsibly.
Leadership assurance	Review systemic issues and management follow-through with executives.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Manager practice and workload diagnostic.
- Capacity review, Kanban and priority-decision toolkit.
- Wellbeing conversation, referral and escalation guide.
- Pilot workshop and 90-day adoption roadmap.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Diagnosis	Managers interpret symptoms as a condition.	Discuss work observations and refer appropriately.
False confidentiality	Information is promised protection that cannot be maintained.	Explain boundaries before disclosure.
Board surveillance	Workflow tools expose personal or sensitive details.	Track work, capacity and blockers only.
WIP inflation	Limits exist but exceptions become normal.	Require a documented trade-off for new active work.
Urgency abuse	Stakeholders bypass priorities through escalation.	Define emergency criteria and decision authority.
Training only	Managers attend but work design does not change.	Measure behaviours and operating outcomes.
Unequal access	Flexible practices favour selected roles or people.	Use transparent criteria and review fairness.
No follow-up	Employees disclose concerns without visible action.	Assign owners, dates and a specific check-back.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

World Health Organization Guidelines on Mental Health at Work. Official source — Evidence-based recommendations covering organizational interventions, manager and worker training, individual interventions, accommodations and return to work.

Canadian Centre for Occupational Health and Safety Workplace Stress Guidance. Official source — Practical Canadian guidance on job demands, role clarity, control, support, recognition, workload and work-life balance.

Mental Health Commission of Canada Implementation Resources. Official source — Free implementation guide, case study findings, promising practices and resources addressing the thirteen psychosocial factors.

UK Health and Safety Executive Stress Tools and Templates. Official source — Free stress indicator, manager competency, focus group, action planning and return-to-work resources.

Predictors of Occupational Burnout Systematic Review. Official source — Open-access review finding evidence that high job demands contribute to burnout and that job resources and work conditions matter.

Communication Application Notifications Strain and Performance Study. Official source — Open-access evidence on cognitive workload, task switching, resumption delay and the effect of digital interruptions.

After-Hours Availability Interventions Systematic Review. Official source — A 2026 open-access review of organizational policies and interventions intended to limit after-hours connectivity and availability expectations.

Ontario Written Policy on Disconnecting from Work. Official source — Current Ontario guidance on the written policy requirement for covered employers and the scope of that requirement.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.